



The Taoist Meditation Journal

Cultivate Stillness,
Follow the Way

MORE SHINE PRESS

Cultivating the Way

For over two thousand years, Taoist meditation has offered a path to inner stillness, harmony with nature, and a deeper understanding of the self. This journal is your companion on that path -- a place to record, reflect, and grow.

The Two-Page Practice Spread

Each session uses a clean two-page spread. The left page captures the essentials: date, practice type, duration, posture, and setting. The right page holds your inner experience: breath observations, sensations, emotions, insights, and a Tao wisdom passage to contemplate.

Practice Types

This journal supports several core Taoist meditation practices: Zuowang (sitting in forgetfulness), Guan (inner observation), Zuochan (sitting meditation), Breathing practice, Inner smile, and Moving meditation. A reference guide on the next pages explains each one.

Five-Session Rhythm

After every five sessions, a reflection page helps you review your progress, notice patterns, and deepen your practice. Use these moments to celebrate growth and adjust your approach.

*The Tao that can be told is not the eternal Tao.
The name that can be named is not the eternal name.*

Zuowang — Sitting in Forgetfulness

The signature Taoist practice of 'sitting and forgetting.' Sit comfortably, close your eyes, and let go of all concepts, identities, and thoughts. Do not resist them -- simply let them pass like clouds. Rest in open awareness.

Guan — Inner Observation

A practice of inward seeing. Turn your attention gently inward to observe the body, breath, and mind without judgment. Notice what is present. Cultivate the quality of a mirror: reflecting without holding.

Zuochan — Still Sitting

The foundational sitting practice. Sit with spine upright, shoulders relaxed, eyes half-closed. Place hands in your lap. Focus on the natural rhythm of breath. When the mind wanders, return.

Breathing Practice — Tu Na

The ancient art of expelling the old and drawing in the new. Breathe slowly and deeply from the abdomen. On each exhale, release tension. On each inhale, gather fresh energy. Let the breath be soft, long, and deep.

Inner Smile

A practice of cultivating inner warmth and kindness. Smile inwardly to each part of your body, beginning with the face, then moving down to the organs. This practice dissolves tension and gathers energy.

Moving Meditation

Tai Chi, Qigong, and mindful walking. Movement becomes meditation when done with full awareness, soft breath, and a settled mind. Practice slow, circular motions that follow the natural flow of energy.

Empty your mind of all thoughts.

Let your heart be at peace.

Watch the turmoil of beings, but contemplate their return.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 16

Begin with the End in Mind

Before you start, take a moment to define what draws you to this practice. What do you hope to cultivate? What does "the Way" mean to you right now?

MY PRIMARY INTENTION FOR THIS PRACTICE

SESSIONS PER WEEK	TARGET DURATION	PREFERRED TIME
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AREAS I WISH TO CULTIVATE

☐ Stillness ☐ Presence ☐ Letting Go ☐ Energy Flow ☐ Emotional Balance ☐ Self-Knowledge
☐ Simplicity ☐ Compassion ☐ Nature Connection ☐ Inner Harmony

WHAT I WANT TO RELEASE

A TAO WISDOM TO GUIDE ME

"A journey of a thousand miles begins beneath your feet."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 64

Session #001 DATE:

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"The Tao that can be told is not the eternal Tao. The name that can be named is not the eternal name."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 1

Session #002 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"The highest good is like water. Water benefits all things and does not contend. It flows in places people reject, and so is like the Tao."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 8

Session #003 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Thirty spokes share one hub. It is the emptiness inside that makes it useful. Shape clay into a vessel; it is the emptiness inside that makes it useful."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 11

Session #004 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Empty yourself of everything. Let the mind rest at peace. The ten thousand things rise and fall while the Self watches their return."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 16

Session #005 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Yield and overcome. Bend and be straight. Empty and be full. Wear out and be new. Have little and gain."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 22

Week 1 — Looking Back, Looking Forward

SESSIONS COMPLETED TOTAL TIME (MIN) AVG. STILLNESS (1-5)

WHAT WORKED WELL THIS WEEK

CHALLENGES OR RESISTANCE

MOST SIGNIFICANT MOMENT OR INSIGHT

WHAT I WANT TO CULTIVATE NEXT WEEK

"Do you have the patience to wait until your mud settles and the water is clear?"
TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 15

Session #006 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Humans follow the earth. Earth follows heaven. Heaven follows the Tao. The Tao follows what is natural."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 25

Session #007 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Knowing others is intelligence. Knowing yourself is true wisdom. Mastering others is strength. Mastering yourself is true power."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 33

Session #008 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"The Tao does nothing, yet nothing is left undone. If leaders could hold to it, all things would transform themselves."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 37

Session #009 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Returning is the motion of the Tao. Yielding is the way of the Tao. All things are born of being. Being is born of non-being."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 40

Session #010 DATE:

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
.....			

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"The softest things in the world overcome the hardest things. That which has no substance enters where there is no space."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 43

Week 2 — Looking Back, Looking Forward

SESSIONS COMPLETED

TOTAL TIME (MIN)

AVG. STILLNESS (1-5)

WHAT WORKED WELL THIS WEEK

CHALLENGES OR RESISTANCE

MOST SIGNIFICANT MOMENT OR INSIGHT

WHAT I WANT TO CULTIVATE NEXT WEEK

"Do you have the patience to wait until your mud settles and the water is clear?"

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 15

Session #011 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Without going outside your door, you can know the ways of the world. Without peeping through your window, you can see the Tao of heaven."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 47

Session #012 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"The sage has no fixed mind. He takes the mind of the people as his own. He is good to those who are good. He is also good to those who are not good."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 49

Session #013 DATE:

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
.....			

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Cultivate virtue in yourself, and virtue will be real. Cultivate it in the family, and virtue will abound. Cultivate it in the community, and virtue will multiply."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 54

Session #014 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"One who is filled with virtue is like a newborn child. Wasps and serpents will not sting, wild beasts will not seize, birds of prey will not strike."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 55

Session #015 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

*"Those who know do not speak. Those who speak do not know. Close your mouth,
block your senses, blunt your sharpness, untie your knots."*

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 56

Week 3 – Looking Back, Looking Forward

SESSIONS COMPLETED TOTAL TIME (MIN) AVG. STILLNESS (1-5)

WHAT WORKED WELL THIS WEEK

CHALLENGES OR RESISTANCE

MOST SIGNIFICANT MOMENT OR INSIGHT

WHAT I WANT TO CULTIVATE NEXT WEEK

"Do you have the patience to wait until your mud settles and the water is clear?"
TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 15

Session #016 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"When the government is lazy and blunt, the people are kind and honest. When the government is strict and demanding, the people are crafty and restless."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 58

Session #017 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Do the difficult while it is easy. Do the great while it is small. The difficult things of the world must be dealt with while they are easy."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 63

Session #018 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"A journey of a thousand miles begins beneath your feet. A tree as wide as a person's embrace grows from a tiny shoot."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 64

Session #019 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Rivers and seas can be kings of all valleys because they stay below. Thus the sage wishes to be above people, and speaks from below."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 66

Session #020 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"When people are born they are soft and weak. When they die they are stiff and hard. All things, including grass and trees, are soft in life and brittle in death."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 76

Week 4 — Looking Back, Looking Forward

SESSIONS COMPLETED TOTAL TIME (MIN) AVG. STILLNESS (1-5)

WHAT WORKED WELL THIS WEEK

CHALLENGES OR RESISTANCE

MOST SIGNIFICANT MOMENT OR INSIGHT

WHAT I WANT TO CULTIVATE NEXT WEEK

"Do you have the patience to wait until your mud settles and the water is clear?"
TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 15

Session #021 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Nothing in the world is softer than water, yet nothing is better at overcoming the hard and strong. The soft overcomes the hard, the gentle overcomes the strong."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 78

Session #022 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Truthful words are not beautiful. Beautiful words are not truthful. Good people do not argue. Those who argue are not good."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 81

Session #023 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Fill your bowl to the brim and it will spill. Keep sharpening your knife and it will blunt. Pursue money and security and your heart will never unclench."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 9

Session #024 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"The five colors blind the eye. The five tones deafen the ear. The five flavors dull the taste. Racing and hunting madden the mind."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 12

Session #025 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

*"Do you have the patience to wait until your mud settles and the water is clear?
Can you remain still until the right action arises by itself?"*

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 15

Week 5 — Looking Back, Looking Forward

SESSIONS COMPLETED TOTAL TIME (MIN) AVG. STILLNESS (1-5)

WHAT WORKED WELL THIS WEEK

CHALLENGES OR RESISTANCE

MOST SIGNIFICANT MOMENT OR INSIGHT

WHAT I WANT TO CULTIVATE NEXT WEEK

"Do you have the patience to wait until your mud settles and the water is clear?"
TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 15

Session #026 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

*"Throw away holiness and wisdom, and people will be a hundred times happier.
Throw away morality and justice, and people will do the right thing."*

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 19

Session #027 DATE:

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"A whirlwind does not last all morning. A sudden rain does not last all day. What is natural does not last long, let alone what is unnatural."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 23

Session #028 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"The heavy is the root of the light. The still is the master of the restless. Thus the sage travels all day without leaving the baggage behind."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 26

Session #029 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"The greatest square has no corners. The greatest vessel takes long to complete. The greatest sound is heard note by note. The greatest form has no shape."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 41

Session #030 DATE: _____

DATE	DAY OF WEEK	DURATION (MIN)	TIME OF DAY
_____	_____	_____	_____

PRACTICE TYPE

☐ Zuowang ☐ Guan ☐ Zuochan ☐ Breathing ☐ Inner Smile ☐ Moving Meditation ☐ Other

POSTURE

☐ Sitting ☐ Standing ☐ Lying ☐ Moving

SETTING

☐ Indoors ☐ Outdoors ☐ Altar Space

HOW I FELT BEFORE PRACTICE

SETTING THE SCENE (CANDLE, INCENSE, MUSIC, POSITION)

BREATH OBSERVATION (RHYTHM, DEPTH, QUALITY)

STILLNESS (1-5)



1 = Restless 5 = Deep Stillness

MENTAL CLARITY (1-5)



1 = Foggy 5 = Crystal Clear

ENERGY (1-5)



1 = Depleted 5 = Vibrant Qi

BODY RELAXATION (1-5)



1 = Tense 5 = Fully Relaxed

SENSATIONS & BODY OBSERVATIONS

EMOTIONS THAT AROSE

INSIGHTS & INTUITIVE KNOWING

HOW I FELT AFTER PRACTICE

"Great accomplishment seems imperfect, yet its use is never exhausted. Great fullness seems empty, yet its use is endless. Great straightness seems bent."

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 45

The Tao that can be told is not the eternal Tao. The name that can be named is not the eternal name. The nameless is the beginning of heaven and earth. The named is the mother of ten thousand things.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 1

The highest good is like water. Water gives life to the ten thousand things and does not strive. It flows in places people reject and so is like the Tao.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 8

Thirty spokes share the center of a wheel. Use the emptiness inside to make it useful. A cup is shaped from clay. Use the emptiness inside to make it useful. A house is built with walls. Use the emptiness inside to make it useful.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 11

Empty yourself of everything. Let the mind rest at peace. The ten thousand things rise and fall while the Self watches their return.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 16

Yield and overcome. Bend and be straight. Empty and be full. Wear out and be new. Have little and gain. Have much and be confused.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 22

Knowing others is intelligence. Knowing yourself is true wisdom. Mastering others is strength. Mastering yourself is true power.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 33

Returning is the motion of the Tao. Yielding is the way of the Tao. The ten thousand things are born of being. Being is born of non-being.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 40

Without going outside your door, you can know the ways of the world. Without peeping through your window, you can see the Tao of heaven.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 47

Act without doing. Work without effort. Think of the small as large and the few as many. Confront the difficult while it is easy.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 63

When people are born they are soft and weak. When they die they are stiff and hard. All things, including the grass and trees, are soft and pliable in life and dry and brittle in death.

TAO TE CHING, CHAPTER 76

*The Tao does nothing,
yet nothing is left undone.*

MORE SHINE PRESS